

The short answer

Today you need only a domain and a static host with HTTPS. The finished app is 156 files, 12 MB in total, with no server and no database. Editing, saving and exporting all happen in the user's browser.

cPanel hosting is enough, but it is not what I'd choose. Every update becomes a manual upload, and someone who opens the app halfway through an upload can get a broken mix of old and new files.

My recommendation is GitHub plus Cloudflare Pages, with your domain staying at Namecheap. It is free, allowed for a business, has a fast global network, renews HTTPS by itself, and publishes automatically every time the code changes.

Two well-known free hosts don't allow a paid product. GitHub Pages forbids commercial sites, and Vercel's free plan is for personal, non-commercial use.

A database only comes with accounts, subscriptions and social posting. cPanel's MySQL and PHP are the wrong tools for that. Use a managed backend; I recommend Supabase.

What any host must do for this app

These come from the actual production build rather than general advice.

REQUIREMENT	WHY	CLOUDFLARE PAGES	CPANEL
HTTPS	Browsers only allow the video encoder and offline mode on secure pages.	AUTOMATIC	AUTOSSL switch on

	Without it, export simply does not exist.		
Correct file types	The app ships <code>.webmanifest</code> , <code>.webm</code> , <code>.woff2</code> and module workers. A wrong type breaks install, previews or export.	AUTOMATIC	NEEDS <code>.HTACCESS</code>
Short caching on two files	<code>index.html</code> and <code>sw.js</code> must never be cached for long, or people keep the old version for days after you publish an update.	NEEDS <code>_HEADERS</code>	NEEDS <code>.HTACCESS</code>
Long caching on the rest	Everything in <code>/assets/</code> has a unique name per build, so it can be cached for a year. That is what makes return visits instant.	NEEDS <code>_HEADERS</code>	NEEDS <code>.HTACCESS</code>
Rewrite rules	None needed. The app is one page and uses only <code>?</code> parameters.	—	—
Special isolation headers	None needed. The app does not use the features that require them.	—	—

I'll add both configuration files to the project as part of the MVP review, so whichever host you choose is a matter of switching it on.

Your options

A. GitHub + Cloudflare Pages + your Namecheap domain RECOMMENDED

Cost: **\$0 a month**, plus the domain at roughly \$10–15 a year. Unlimited bandwidth, up to 500 publishes a month, and a 25 MB limit per file, against our largest of 2 MB.

1

Put the code on GitHub, as a private repository

The project is already tracked with git, so this is a single push.

2 Create a free Cloudflare account and connect the repository

Workers & Pages, then Create, then Pages, then connect to GitHub and pick the repository.

3 Enter the build settings

Framework preset

Vite

, build command

`npm run build`

, output folder

`dist`

, and an environment variable

`NODE_VERSION`

set to

`22`

.

4 Connect your domain

In the Pages project, open Custom domains and add yours. The simplest route is to point the domain's nameservers at Cloudflare from your Namecheap dashboard. The domain stays registered with Namecheap and Cloudflare handles DNS for free.

5 Publish by pushing

Every change pushed to the main branch goes live in about a minute. Every other branch gets its own private preview address, which is how you test before your users see anything.

B. cPanel shared hosting (Namecheap, SpeedyConnect or similar)

WORKS, WITH FRICTION

Cost: whatever your hosting plan costs, often \$2–10 a month. Fine for the MVP.

1 Build on your computer

Run

`npm run build`

It creates the

. It creates the

`dist`
folder.

2 Upload the contents of `dist` into `public_html`

Use cPanel File Manager or FTP. Upload the files inside the folder, not the folder itself, and include the

`.htaccess`
I'll provide.

3 Turn on HTTPS

Run AutoSSL or Let's Encrypt in cPanel's SSL/TLS section, and redirect all visits to HTTPS (the

`.htaccess`
does this).

4 Repeat steps 1 and 2 for every update

This is the weak point: it is manual, there are no previews, and a half-finished upload can break the app for anyone who loads it at that moment. Shared hosts also limit file counts and rarely have a global network.

HOST	VERDICT	WHY
Cloudflare Pages	YES	Free, allowed for business, fast everywhere, publishes from GitHub.
cPanel shared hosting	WORKS	Fine for static files. Manual updates, no previews, usually no global network.
Vercel Pro	WORKS, PAID	\$20 per user per month. The free Hobby plan forbids commercial use.
GitHub Pages	NO	Its terms forbid commercial sites. Use GitHub to store the code, not to host the app.
A VPS or your own server	NOT NOW	You'd be maintaining a server for an app that doesn't need one.

What each roadmap feature will need

None of this is needed for the MVP. It's listed so the hosting choice you make now still fits later. Everything below plugs into the Cloudflare route without moving anything.

FEATURE	SERVICE	STARTING COST
Sign-in with Apple, Google and email	Supabase Auth. Google needs a free Google Cloud project; Apple needs the Apple Developer Program. Email sign-in needs a sending service such as Resend.	Supabase free tier to build; Apple \$99 a year
Profiles, plans, organisations	Supabase database. The free tier pauses after a week without visits, so production needs the Pro plan.	\$25 a month (Pro)
FREE, PRO, PRO MAX subscriptions	Stripe on the web, including invoices for organisations. A small function updates the user's plan when Stripe confirms a payment. Add RevenueCat later for the App Store and Google Play.	About 3% per payment, no monthly fee
Connected social accounts and posting	A server is required: platform tokens must never live in the browser. Supabase Edge Functions for the logic, a scheduled job for timed and bulk posting, and file storage (Cloudflare R2) to hold each video while it is posted.	R2 is a few cents per GB stored
Errors and usage	Sentry for crash reports and Cloudflare Web Analytics for privacy-friendly visits.	Free tiers

Namecheap · domain → Cloudflare · DNS, hosting, R2 → GitHub · code →
Supabase · accounts, data, functions → Stripe · subscriptions

Three things to plan for before building those features

1

Posting to social media changes the privacy promise

The app currently says nothing leaves your device. To post through Instagram's or TikTok's API, the video has to sit at a public web address their servers can fetch, so it must be uploaded first. The honest promise becomes "nothing leaves your device unless you choose to post it". Delete each file as soon as it has been posted.

2

Every platform must approve your app before it can post for users

- **Instagram:** business and creator accounts only, after Meta reviews your app. Each account can publish up to 100 posts through the API in 24 hours.

- **TikTok:** until your app passes TikTok's audit, every post it makes is forced to private and only 5 users can post per day.
- **LinkedIn, YouTube and X:** each has its own approval, quota or paid API tier.

Applying takes weeks. A posting service such as Ayrshare already holds these approvals and sells access monthly, which is the faster way to launch bulk posting. You can build your own connections later.

3

Watermark and PRO MAX rules will run on the user's device

Export happens in the browser, so the check for PRO and PRO MAX elements happens there too. That is enough to stop ordinary users. A technical user could get around any check that runs on their own machine, which is normal for apps like this, but it means PRO MAX limits are a deterrent rather than a lock. The only true lock would be rendering on your servers, which costs money for every video.

Running costs at each stage

STAGE	MONTHLY	WHAT IT INCLUDES
MVP launch	≈ \$1	Domain only. Hosting on Cloudflare Pages is free.
With accounts and subscriptions	≈ \$35	Supabase Pro, a share of the Apple Developer fee, and Stripe's cut of each payment.
With social posting	\$35 plus usage	Video storage while posting, plus either a posting service's monthly plan or any paid API tier you choose (X's, for example).

SOURCES

- [Cloudflare Pages limits](#)
- [Vercel terms: Hobby is personal, non-commercial use only](#)
- [Supabase pricing in 2026](#)
- [TikTok content sharing guidelines](#)
- [Instagram content publishing](#)